STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-5000
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 06/01/06	DATE REVISED **11/24/25**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT HIGH RISK INCIDENTS	CROSS REFERENCE G-10410 FIELD COMMAND POST P-4800 CRIME INVESTIGATION P-4810 CRIME SCENE P-5010 HIGH RISK INCIDENT COMMAND P-5020 ACTIVE SHOOTER			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish procedures for containing and resolving high risk incidents.

II. Policy:

The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office recognizes the extreme danger created by high risk incidents such as a barricaded, armed individual or a hostage situation. A proper response is required to limit the potential for death or serious injury to deputies, civilians, and the subjects. The actions of first responders, usually uniform Road Patrol deputies, are critical in saving lives.

Duties of the first responders include the protection of life, the evacuation of injured parties and innocent civilians, the isolation and containment of the subject, and the initial intelligence gathering.

The most valuable asset available to responding deputies is time. Time, controlling the subject, and controlling his or her immediate surroundings are the most important requirements for achieving a successful resolution of a high risk incident. The longer an incident lasts the more likely a peaceful resolution.

The following procedures are not intended to be all inclusive but act as a guide for the appropriate response to a high risk incident. Depending on the circumstances, responding deputies may need to follow active shooter procedures (see P-5020 Active Shooter).

III. Definitions:

A. **HIGH RISK INCIDENT:** Any event with a subject(s) at a known location where there exists a high probability of the subject causing death or serious bodily injury. The subject may be alone and armed (i.e. barricaded subject) or have control over other individuals (i.e. hostage situation). High risk incidents may result from: a domestic disturbance, an arrest situation, a suicide attempt, a criminal attempt (e.g. robbery, burglary, assault, etc.), a traffic stop, a warrant service, or other events. Generally, a high risk incident shall not include an active shooter, but a contained active shooter may become a high risk incident (see P-5020 Active Shooter).

IV. Procedures:

A. **Initial Response-Deputy Responsibilities:** Deputies responding to incidents that may be or may become a high-risk incident shall adhere to the following procedures.

1. Deputies should position their patrol units in a safe location.

2. Deputies should observe the location from a position of cover.

3. Deputies should detain any individuals leaving or near the location to determine their involvement.

4. Deputies should gather information and make an assessment regarding the existence of a high-risk incident. The assessment may be based upon:

- **a)** Prior knowledge of the subject.
- **b)** Personal observations.
- **c)** Information obtained from Communications.
- **d)** Information obtained from victims or witnesses.
- **e)** Contact with the subject.

5. Factors to consider to determine the existence of a high risk incident:

- **a)** Is the subject alone or does he or she have control of others (e.g. family members)?
- **b)** Has the subject committed a crime?
- **c)** What are the subject's capabilities:
  - **(1)** How is the subject armed and what are the weapon's capabilities?
  - **(2)** What is the subject's range of movement?
- **d)** Is the subject a danger to himself or herself or others?
- **e)** Why has the subject taken this action?
- **f)** Have shots been fired?

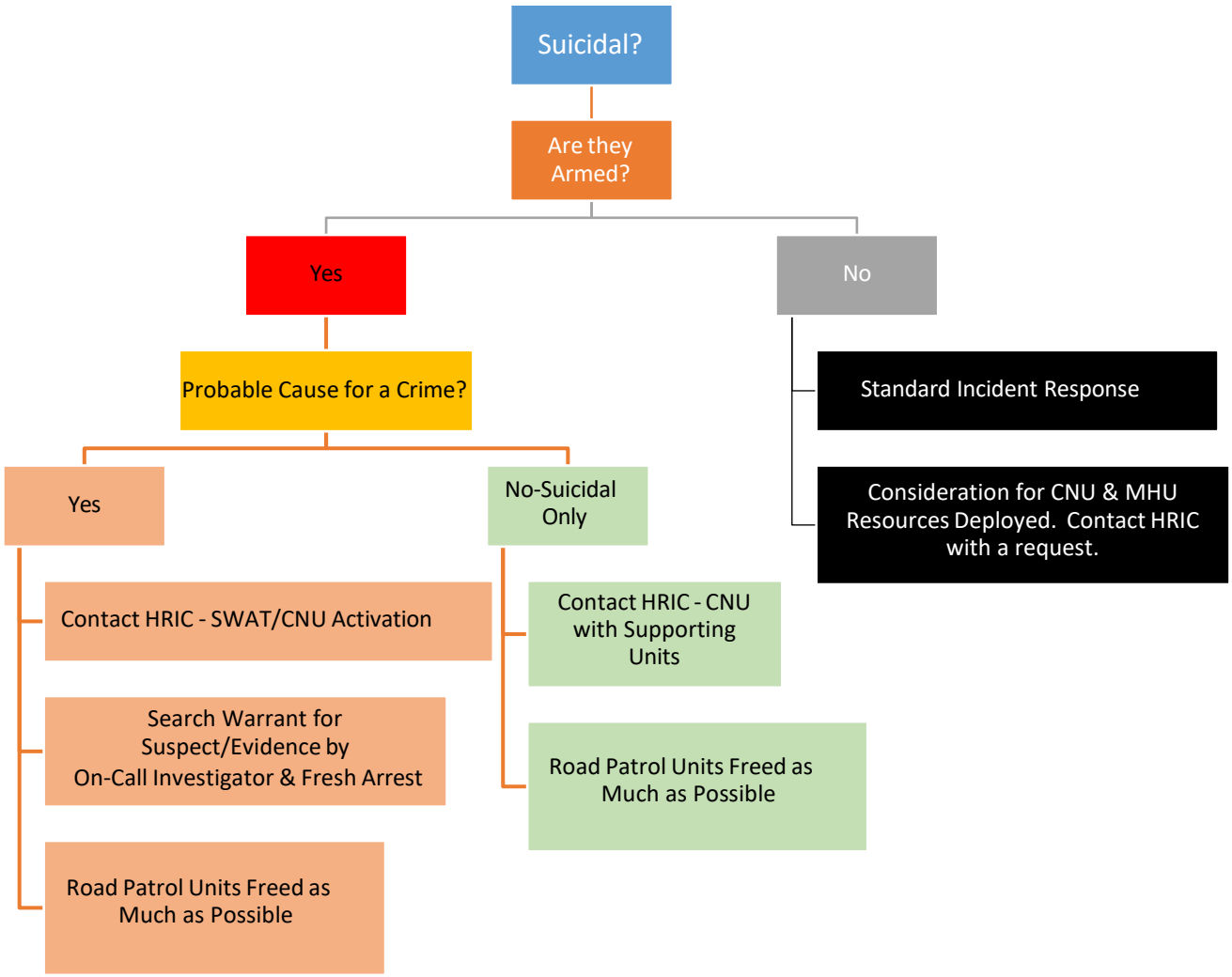
g) Are there any injured persons?

6. If a deputy believes a high-risk incident exists, he or she shall:

a) Notify the on-duty supervisor.
b) Request additional deputies.
c) Continue to monitor from a safe location.
d) Provide current information to Communications and responding deputies.
e) If possible, confine the suspect to the immediate area.
f) Report to the field command post upon being properly relieved and await further assignment.

7. The initial deputy shall be responsible for completing an incident report.

B. **Suicidal Party Matrix:** Supervisors and the High-Risk Incident Commander shall consult the matrix below to jointly aid in deciding what resources are deployed, and how the plans are developed when attempting to resolve a high-risk incident.



C. High Risk Incident-Supervisor Responsibilities: The on-duty shift supervisor shall respond to all high risk incidents. The on-scene shift supervisor shall:

1. Immediately notify the High Risk Incident Commander (see P-5010 High Risk Incident Command) and provide current information. The High Risk Incident Commander shall authorize the notification of all appropriate personnel (e.g. Sarpy County SWAT, Crisis Negotiations Unit, Investigations, etc.).

2. Notify the on-duty watch commander or the ADC. The ADC shall be responsible for any public notifications for awareness and safety.

3. Notify the on-call Investigator of the incident. If a search warrant is required, the Supervisor shall direct the on-call Investigator to the appropriate deputy or deputies for gathering the necessary facts to support the search affidavit.

4. Establish a field command post (see G-10410 Field Command Post) and direct all responding deputies to report to the command post for assignment.

5. Determine the need for evacuation of the immediate and surrounding locations and implement an evacuation plan, if safe to do so. If an evacuation is not possible, advise those in the area to “shelter in place”.

6. Establish an inner perimeter to contain the suspect.

a) If manpower allows, deputies should be assigned to inner perimeter positions in pairs.

b) Inner perimeter positions should be chosen:

(1) To afford cover.
(2) To create a “reactionary gap.”
(3) To provide an escape route for deputies.
(4) To prevent cross-fire situations.
(5) To cover all possible exits from the location.

7. Establish an outer perimeter to isolate the subject and prevent unauthorized individuals from entering the scene.

8. Begin a log of all activities and all assignments.

9. Coordinate with local law enforcement agencies for assistance at the incident and/or with calls for service within the Sheriff’s Office’s jurisdiction.

10. Request Communications assign a separate radio talkgroup for the incident and ensure that all personnel are on the assigned talkgroup.

11. Assist the High Risk Incident Commander upon his or her arrival.

12. Upon the arrival of auxiliary units, Road Patrol deputies shall be returned to service as soon as practical, so long as their presence is not further needed for scene security, transport of prisoners, etc.

D. **Intelligence Gathering at a High Risk Incident:** The shift supervisor may begin this process, and the High Risk Incident Commander may designate a deputy or investigator to complete this task. Intelligence gathering includes:

1. Initial Reconnaissance by the shift supervisor:

a) A sketch of the exterior shall be prepared including:

(1) Doors and windows.
(2) Visible utility connections.
(3) Potential hazards.
(4) Barriers and Fences.
(5) Animals.

b) If possible, a sketch of the interior shall be prepared.

2. Records Check: If possible, a records check of the subject(s) shall be conducted with Communications including:

a) Prior arrests and convictions.
b) Outstanding warrants.
c) Previous history of mental health warrants.
d) Local law enforcement contact history.
e) Vehicle registrations.
f) Location history (based on address and call history).

3. Personal Information: The subject's personal information shall be obtained from family and friends, to include:

a) Military training and background.
b) Medical and psychological history.
c) Employment and education history.
d) Marital status and family information.
e) Religious affiliation, hobbies, and interests.

E. **Resolution of a High Risk Incident:** The first responding deputies and shift supervisor may be required to resolve a high risk incident.

1. **Arrest Plan**: The shift supervisor and the responding deputies should formulate an arrest plan as soon as possible in the event the subject surrenders or initial negotiations prove successful.

   a) Only one deputy should give commands to the subject.
   b) Communications should be contacted to clear the air for emergency traffic only.
   c) Deputies should never leave a position of cover. The subject should be directed to a safe location**.**
   d) The subject should be ordered to raise his or her hands to expose any weapons.
   e) The subject should be ordered into a kneeling position, position of disadvantage.
   f) The subject should be provided continued reassurance.
   g) Deputies should approach only when the subject has complied with all commands and only with lethal cover.

2. **Rescue Plan:** An rescue plan should be formulated as soon as possible, but should only be implemented as a last resort to save lives (see P-5020 Active Shooter).

3. **Completion of High Risk Incident:** After the high risk incident is resolved, the location shall be treated as a crime scene and an investigation shall be completed (see P-4800 Crime Investigation and P-4810 Crime Scene). The shift supervisor shall ensure that all appropriate incident and supplemental reports are completed.

F. Response to Non-Criminal Barricaded Suicidal Subject:

1. Private Residences:

   a) A suicidal subject in their own home or on their own property is protected from unreasonable search and seizure under the Fourth Amendment. Warrantless entry into their home can only be made if there is an immediate crisis, the assistance will be helpful, and the sole purpose for entering is to render aid for a severe or life-threating injury. Consequently, intrusion into the home to administer aid to a subject with no injuries or non-life-threatening injuries may render the entry and subsequent seizure unconstitutional.

2. Operational Guidelines:

   a) Initial welfare checks of suicidal subject in their own residence or on their own property are primarily the responsibility of the Road Patrol Division.

b) Non-criminal barricaded suicidal subjects in a private residence can be approached with a multi-disciplinary cooperative response from the Road Patrol, Mental Health Unit and Crisis Negotiation Team.

c) Communication attempts shall be made. If communicate with the subject is established, maintain communication as assess the need for further action or response. Consider the following:

(1) Is the subject a danger to themselves or others?
(2) Is the subject alone?
(3) Why has the subject taken this action?

d) If productive communication occurs, deputies and other responders can remain on scene to provide needed care.

e) Strategic disengagement may become a viable option for incident resolution under the following circumstance:

(1) If communication is established but the subject then ends communication, and there is no imminent threat to the public, the incident may be concluded without making further contact.

(a) Simply being armed while alone, does not constitute an imminent threat.

(2) If communication becomes unproductive and the subject refuses assistance from the resources being offered.

(3) If a third party reported the threat and the subject does not make a suicidal threat, no further response is required.

f) The final strategic disengagement determination rests with the HRIC, in coordination with other commanders involved in the incident.

g) Any strategic disengagement decision shall be documented in a report and shall include a description of assistance that was offered to the subject.

h) Strategic Disengagement Statement:

(1) It is recommended that the following verbal statement be given to the neighbors, family members, etc. anytime the decision is made to withdraw from the incident scene.

(a) *"The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office is giving notice to all persons directly affected by this event that after considering the factors affecting the safety of all concerned, the safest course of action is for our personnel to disengage and withdraw from the vicinity. If a new emergency develops, please call 911."*

G. A documented annual review of policy and training needs shall be conducted.